

Interviewer: I haven't --- I wasn't able to formally introduce myself to [Name] as well. Medyo parang nag-ano na kami tumalon na agad sa...

Speaker: Well I know your Is this Ate so hello Ate.

Interviewer: Yes yes. I'm [6-10] years older than her pero kami iyong magkasunod. So thank you for accommodating my request for the participating in this interview. And I'll just go through my preliminaries as mentioned over the email correspondence. We want to know more about your views on romantic relationships. Of course, part of that is we will talk about relationships in general.

Interviewer: But of course, we will also focusing on your relationship, your marriage with [Partner's Name] particularly. So we are now recording and then I will also be taking down notes so that I can also capture you know while there's recording but I will try to capture also what you will be sharing in this interview session. Alright, so do you have any questions? So I think, I hope you were able to see the consent form. So isang consent form na lang for the two of you.

Speaker: Yeah, no problem.

Interviewer: Yes, and then at the same time yung data sharing kasi we can talk about that later. Meron na ring preferred data sharing si [Partner's Name] but it might also be different kung anong gusto mong data sharing but we can discuss that once the interview is over.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: Alright. So first question or first set of questions will focus on demographics. So how old are you?

Speaker: Okay, I'm [41-45] turning [41-45] in a couple of weeks ayon.

Interviewer: Malapit na ang birthday ni [Participant's Name].

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So how long have you been together with your partner? By the way, sir kasi syempre si [Partner's Name]. So anong preferred niyong...

Speaker: [Participant's Name] na lang din. Please call me [Participant's Name] na lang.

Interviewer: Okay, [Participant's Name]. Alright, so how long have you been together with your wife, [Partner's Name]?

Speaker: Ah married, our marriage or as a couple?

Interviewer: As a couple as a couple.

Speaker: So since [Year].

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: Wait [field] ako eh so I'm poor at math right now. Ilan na ba yun?

Interviewer: [11-15], about [11-15].

Speaker: [11-15] years yeah.

Interviewer: Yes, yes. Including this year.

Speaker: Tama ba?

Interviewer: About [11-15].

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So kasama yung hindi pa kayo married, yes.

Speaker: Yes, but that's when we became boyfriend-girlfriend.

Interviewer: Right, of course I've also asked this from [Partner's Name] already. But do you have children? Just to document because separate recording.

Speaker: Oo --- yes, we have [1-5]. One is [11-15] and the others five, both the girls.

Interviewer: Okay. And who lives in the household?

Speaker: The [1-5] of us. So yeah, just the [1-5] of us.

Interviewer: Right, so it doesn't have to be so specific but what is your main source of income?

Speaker: So in full-time employment and I'm with [Company]. So I'm with [department]. And I'm with [department] primarily. And then several other things here and there within [Company] also. I mean, other roles are given to me. But the primary is that it's a full-time employment in [Company].

Interviewer: All right.

Speaker: [Department].

Interviewer: All right.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: So now for some context or general overview about your relationship with [Partner's Name], can you tell me about your love story? ayan Love story. Doesn't have to be too much detail but just a general idea of the love story.

Speaker: Okay. Well, we first met in technically [Year]. When we first met. She's one year younger than I am. So that would have been around [Month] I would approximate. I was [position] of an org and she was an applicant. Okay and then as things would have it, I interviewed her even if I told the group then that I as a senior and as the head would no longer be interviewing just so that the younger officers sana would have a more exposure. But as things would have it, biglang nag-precut sa class namin. And so I went back to the org room. And then sa dami kailangan interbyuhin. So I said, fine. Baliin ko na muna yung sarili kong rule that I created for the group. And I asked for some apps, application forms. And then, well, I chose her. I didn't know her. But out of a bunch of 10 probably ayon I picked her application dahil wel, there was a cuteness to it.

Speaker: I don't really mention it to you parang most of her younger photos, even her more recent ones, kasi lagi siyang may tilt. So I found that oh okay cute. Fine, parang I have a habit rin naman kasi na parang

to have fun while doing work. So parang diba might as well so parang okay, let's see tapos, yun so that's when we first met. We hit it off quite nicely yung parang we got along, parang the vibes were there, et cetera. So this is definitely a good person tipong ganon so a good friend to have. And that was that, na parang of course, she passed based on her own merits and whatnot ganyan. And then, so that was my senior year that was her junior year. But pretty much during those that year, we remained friends, found other things in common and that friendship stayed on.

Speaker: Okay and in between that time and the time that we got together, which was [Year] na, I think I was in [1-5] more relationships. She, I think had [1-5] or something like that within that period. But we remained friends tipong ganon. Long-distance friends even, kasi I was really based in [City B] she was here to South. But so phone calls, text messages na yun yung pala yung time. So we just kept in touch and then, but the entire time, kung бага I really had a certain admiration for her as a person. And I'd focus more on the admiration than the attraction. The attraction was there parang, I mean, she's so. A lot marami akong ibang friends din, or na may crush sa kanya. She will never admit it na may pagka-crush ng bayan yun. But it was an admiration really and then it came to a point in my life. So in [Year] na, so I was about [26-30] na, but in [Date].

Speaker: After the last relationship, where I did a lot of, not a lot, I did a deeper reflection of life and relationships and all and parang I had a game plan where one of the things I wanted to do was to cherish more of the friendships I had that I may have not been able to focus on as much or spend as much time now with certain people. And one of those were, one of those people was [Partner's Name] at that time. So we reconnected ng mga bagay ganon and as things would have it, we were both single at that time. Not really looking. I don't think she was looking for a relationship na I don't, I wasn't looking in particular talaga. But wala lang, again, the vibes were just there.

Speaker: And then, parang ayon so at a certain point, friendly dates or friendly meetups, and then we just sort of feel these things and then more and more the feelings got stronger and then it was easy to sort of pursue the feelings kasi na we were very comfortable with each other anyway. We knew each other fairly well. We had a lot of conversations about mundane things or deeper things. So it felt natural. But more than anything, why I decided to, let's try this, let's try to have a relationship despite the fear, the usual fear of, ay friend ko to eh, and she's a good friend ayon and if this doesn't work out, then you lose two things di ba. Eh ako pa naman, I don't I'm typically, yeah I have nothing against my exes but I choose not to be really friends with them.

Speaker: So nandun lagi yung thought na yun na okay, if we get together and it doesn't work out, andaming mawawala. So it was really a risk it felt like a big risk. But then, I knew that and I articulated it this way to one of my high school barkada iyong mga kabarkada namin iyong mga nag sabi ko, you know, ano siya eh, she's my standard of a good woman sabi ko. And it just hit me, di ba parang, eh siya na nga yung standard eh, so why not go for the standard di ba

Interviewer: Right right.

Speaker: So yun and also kasi, I found a script that I had then that I knew I had to break, parang, all my previous relationships were with women who were in a sense that stereotypical textbook damsel, damsels in distress. And I have my own reflections and speculations as to why they were, I was attracted to them or why I attracted that type then. But di nga there was always something in me that said, this is not what I really want or need in my life. So a lot of turning points talaga nung [Year]. And it just so happened you

know na things were also happening with us ni [Partner's Name] so yun and then I pursued it and pretty much that's how it was but I'd like to share a little detail if it's okay.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: Na when I professed my real feelings to her. As in yung moment of professing love. There's a way that, kasi we share these with students so we run some talks and there's a way of packaging this that I'll spare you the drama of it. But, there was a moment that was I would put as a kiss moment. There's always a, that moment simply that you'd have as depicted in movies and stories at even in real life. So it was there. The feelings were professed, feelings were mutual, et cetera. So it was a kiss moment and the atmosphere was co-operative, everything.

Speaker: And then, I didn't take it, but simply. And I told her na I'm not taking this right now. Though I want to, though I can, because I need to prove to myself that I do love you. Parang sorry pa ang bahala na if you get it or not. But it's something I need to do. Cuase, iba ka eh for me, iba ka. So I have to do things differently also. I have to be very careful, mindful of my actions hindi lang bugso ng damdamin and so on and so forth. So yun and then from there, from that moment, and that was still in [Month] of [Year] actually, ayon nagpatuloy-tuloy na di ba. By [Year], I proposed. [Year], we got married. [Year], our first born came and so on and so forth. And here we are now. [11-15] years after then so yun.

Interviewer: Thank you. Thank you for you know, thank you for all that. Maybe you can compare notes later with [Partner's Name].

Speaker: Oh, alright. Sige.

Interviewer: Yeah, but I think what's, what I'm getting here is of course the, that it started off as friendship. And then, you know, it went from later into more romantic relationship. And I think that's also the story provided by [Partner's Name] a while ago. So thank you for that. And I'm noting of course, some of the key points that you mentioned in that story, baka kasi lumabas ulit later in the succeeding questions. Now, even the kind of you know given how you in with that detail of your love story, I would like to focus more on the relationship quality at present. So how would you compare?

Speaker: At present, okay.

Interviewer: Yeah. So let's say the quality of your relationship with [Partner's Name], how would you compare the quality of your relationship with [Partner's Name] compared to that of your let's say friends relationships. So it's a comparing your relationship with [Partner's Name] and let's say yung mga alam mong relationships ng mga friends mo. In terms of what?

Speaker: Yeah, well siguro right now, I guess, of course, like broad ng friends di ba. I'll give my answer based on just my closest mate of guy friends yung, well, kaming mga high school barkada again, I would be part of that. In relation to that barakada at least, kasi kami yung sabay-sabay mga lumaki essentially. I would say we're all blessed that our relationships are fairly, are quite, I would say healthy. I would say it's even so quote-unquote vanilla, but that's a good thing. The vanilla garden variety na yung parang no-no, hindi masyadong madrama, hindi masalimuot.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: It's quite stable, quite yung parang almost yung parang there's a certain progression di ba yung parang, from being friends or being boyfriend-girlfriend, at all of us naman started as friends, friends, yung parang, boyfriend was at a boyfriend-girlfriend and at a certain point, engaged and at a certain point, married and at a certain point, started having kids and so on and so forth. Fortunately, for most of us, medyo ganoon lang yung unfolding.

Interviewer: Right right.

Speaker: So yeah and but in relation to other friends outside of that. Yeah, I would still say now, well I guess my set of friends lang kasi are more, are more, ano ba? Well, wala masyadong madrama that we know of.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: Not without problems. Well when I say drama yung tipong pang pelikulang drama na ay may kabit or may you know, whatever, yung parang super dramatic, problems here and there fine, I think that's part of everything. So yun, I'm thankful and happy that it's that way, I guess. And I have older friends and I look at their relationships also and I say, oh okay. What can I learn from them? Being older, some of them are most of them, thankfully also have very stable healthy relationships naman. So yun, so if in relation to yun nga sets of friends that are that I would consider closer to or of friends, I'd say we're all equally blessed in a sense na and things are as they ought to be where there's that healthy element of challenges but more of you know good things, in a sense.

Interviewer: Right yeah, thank you.

Speaker: Yeah, I don't know if that helps.

Interviewer: I think, well, if correct me if I'm wrong, what I'm getting is your concept of, let's say, let's say in comparison, it seems like you're saying that they're not, your relationship, your current, your relationship with [Partner's Name], your marriage with [Partner's Name] is quite comparable in terms of quality with the quality of relationships of your friends.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: And there was a keyword that you mentioned, something on stability and progression and things both you know the way should they should be and stability I'm getting is the way you mentioned yung progression, yung parang may expectations and they're happening accordingly without so much.

Speaker: Yeah, oo.

Interviewer: Okay. I hope na I was able to capture yung concept right. Now, another comparison here is if I may also ask you to compare again, where's my other guide question? Sorry. Yeah, so in comparison to, so have you compared it to, I think I'm missing one question, but anyway, let me just go over my, you know, I'll just follow my questions.

Speaker: Sure, sure.

Interviewer: Yup. Ah, there I found it, sorry. How would you now compare as well your current relationship with that of your previous relationships? So, a while ago, you're comparing your relationship with that of your friends.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Now, how would you compare the quality of your relationship relative to the previous relationships that you've had? And if it's okay to ask.

Speaker: Ah okay.

Interviewer: I think you did mention a while ago, you've had previous relationships before [Partner's Name].

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: And if it's okay to ask, how many partners have you had in the past before [Partner's Name]?

Speaker: Officially, [1-5]?

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Yeah, yung tipong long term na may kinikilala talaga parang dating or what ganyan I'm not counting those na lang but so [1-5].

Interviewer: [1-5]. Right. And so, based on that, sorry but and based on those two relationships, let's say, how would you now compare this relationship with those two other relationships? Yeah, just to give context to that question.

Speaker: Okay. it's definitely healthier, definitely more, two words come to mind parang consoling even and it brings a certain ano pa eh I'd use the word peace pero mas maganda yung Filipino na parang kapayapaan yung payapa you know. One aspect I would pinpoint as to why to closer like the dominant feelings about what [Partner's Name] and I have or even what we had even before. We see each other as partners eh parang a healthy dose of dependence and independence.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: So, parang swak lang eh. Whereas, as I mentioned earlier in a passing di ba, the past relationships tended to be with women who were ano eh damsels in distress.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: Parang of course, I didn't know at the onset but it just sort of emerged to be such and then upon reflection looking back parang oh it was a pattern. And while it felt there was a certain I would say, a certain quote-unquote gratification but there was also a certain discontent and unrest a certain restlessness with it with those.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: But that I didn't feel with [Partner's Name] at the start even up to now. So yun healthier, peaceful, parang secure also feels more secure, and many other things. And I guess, it aligns it's also a lot of alignment of values.

Interviewer: Right. Yeah. Alignment of values.

Speaker: Oo, may alignment that you know you don't align it intentionally. They just align. They're, either aligned or they're not di ba so thankfully there's an alignment of that. Just to share again, I don't really mention this. So, I think before we became a couple you know the flirty guy in me asked her lang once. parang ano lang, can you give me a list of top ten qualities you'd like to you would you'd look for in a guy. So, bangit siya one, two, three. Typical things so family oriented, makadiyos, blah, blah, blah so mga ganyan. So, one, two, three, four, five, seven, eight, nine and at the tenth thing, what she said was, may malasakit sa bayan.

Speaker: So, parang putcha. Oh you don't hear that as often from you know women who would say that they look for that in a partner. So, parang ah okay okay. Incidentally, around that time, I was organizing, I was co-organizing a big youth event that was focused on you know nationalism and good citizenship and so on and so forth. And incidentally, I needed a co-host for that. So, sabi ko ah malasakit sa bayan pala. Oh, tara let's do this para hatakin kita. And so, we co-hosted that thing it was called [Event] thing where we had about a little over 2,000 youth from all over the [Country]. It was two and a half day camp et cetera mga ganon. So yun, parang just to alignment of values na hindi pinilit eh.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: Di ba hindi and you didn't need have to negotiate your values because sometimes it happens you heavily negotiate or renegotiate your values. And it didn't have, I didn't have to, and neither I think did she have to. So yun so, in relation to other previous relationships yun po yung I'd like to share.

Interviewer: Yeah. Thank you. At least, you know, you were able to concretely pinpoint what you mean by you know when you were trying to talk about the current and of course the current from the previous relationships that you've had. And I think the key points there, I noted a lot but I think the last part that you said is quite crucial the alignment of values. And of course, I also noted the thing that you just mentioned about a healthy dose of that dependence and independence yeah.

Speaker: Yeah yeah.

Interviewer: And the peace, and I think you've also mentioned something like the relationship is consoling.

Speaker: Oo.

Interviewer: And the term kapayapaan was also mentioned.

Speaker: Yeah yeah.

Interviewer: Now, still focusing on relationship quality. How would you or what makes a relationship high quality versus let's say a low quality? So, if you can just expound on you know your idea of a high quality relationship versus a low quality.

Speaker: All right. Well, a number of things come to mind immediately. One is mutual respect where that's manifest that respect mutual respect this is manifested through a certain acceptance of the other. Second would be what I mentioned previously yung alignment of values. All right and when and of course it's never perfectly aligned. So the third thing I would say is that openness and the I mean the openness and the readiness to communicate or not even readiness the willingness to communicate. Parang tara pag-

usapan natin to let's see what you mean. And with that also is and I mean part of communications there also the readiness and willingness to listen.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: And then so maybe a fourth thing would be yun eh yung healthy co-dependence eh for me. I've seen people na or men na lang qualities of men in relationships wherein gusto nila I guess basta there's a certain preference where they do everything. All right. I think in itself hindi naman mali di ba one might one would want to do everything for the other di ba but in reality you can't eh di ba. And sometimes the failure or the denial of admitting that you really can't, leads to an unhealthy point where things actually start crumbling or nagiging inversely beneficial you wanted it you wanted this as a good thing for your partner but in your denial that you or that delusion delulu di ba ang tawag ngayon ng mga kabataan.

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: Na di magagawa ko toh ganyan ganyan whether it's small things or big things mas minsan mas nasasaktan yung relationship I think. I have my own thoughts on that or ego or whatnot because with the co-dependence there's that admission of yun na who you are and what you are and what you can and cannot exactly do di ba and with it is the trust and I guess that's the element also that the other will pull through for both of you somehow di ba. Kasi trust is what allows someone to depend on another di ba so siguro maybe those four.

Speaker: And then at the fifth I would have is a sense is that a certain spirituality that you share the couple would share beyond religiosity but of course religious practices and all of that are manifestations that certain spirituality and faith that you both have and reinforce excuse me parang it's the it's the X factor perhaps eh parang there's only so much both of you could do and then there's that X factor God, faith that you need to at least for me for us that you need to acknowledge that is there that's making these things work. So it's beyond the two of us also if and when we have problems or what not may sandigan pa eh may kakapitan pa may bumubulong pa sayo what to do and so on and so forth so maybe those five things.

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay thank you right. So if you can just flip the coin I know maybe we can just think about the opposite of the things that you said but if you can qualify what you think is a low quality relationship just to make sure that we're able to or your ideas on relationship quality.

Speaker: Actually the word that comes to mind when you mentioned low quality is parang unhealthy relationships I mean that's how I'm sort of framing it in my mind. And what would be unhealthy relationships, one is yung I guess it's a battle almost a war of egos whatever way those would manifest na parang one has to assert himself herself too much or unhealthy competitiveness, unhealthy levels of insecurity ano pa which di ba nandun yung mistrust tuloy nandun din yung mga pagkamartir I would say eh. They're sort of random they're not they're sirely connected na yung pagkamartir din andami ding taong pamartir eh.

Interviewer: Oo.

Speaker: Yeah, akong ng bahala dito sige na sige na sige kahit saktan mo ko mahal kita. Yeah but it doesn't parang ultimately parang I think an unhealthy or low quality relationship fails to focus fails to acknowledge and work on individual as well as mutual growth na parang they might say no we want that we want that but a lot of the things they do don't actually parang ultimately contribute to that di ba so yun parang.

Interviewer: Oo yeah.

Speaker: may ganon eh and a lot of it I would also contribute to failure to understand to listen to communicate.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: Di ba walang.

Interviewer: That's right

Speaker: Yeah I guess I would say those yeah.

Interviewer: Okay, thank you yeah. So actually they're not exactly the opposite of the things you said but some are there there's high quality indicators high quality relationship indicators and the low quality relationship indicators. So thank you for that but now just to cap our the question on relationship quality if you were to the most if you were to look into these answers that you shared with me what would you consider as the most important thing in the relationship so you mentioned five items.

Speaker: So one? yeah yeah.

Interviewer: So if you were to you know holistically look at relationships in general what do you think is the most important thing in a relationship and of course the follow up question is why.

Speaker: Most important kasi ang hirap non eh kasi like the five I mentioned to some extent I told them with much much preciousness and value talaga eh parang sensible test five I mean medyo parang independently they're good but the synergy is greater than the sum of its part so.

Interviewer: Yes yes

Speaker: But I would if I were to I guess summarize it into another idea it would really be the desire to want I mean the desire for what is good for the other. Knowing that in order for you to give what is what is good for the other you need to also work on yourself. Okay let me clean that up a little bit more, parang I want what's good I'll put it as if it were a dialogue "I want what's good for you, I want to be able to give you what will make you happy, what will make you satisfied, what will make you feel fulfilled and so on and so forth about all the good things I want for you". But I can actually only really give that to you if I also at the same time di ba work on myself.

Interviewer: Yeah right.

Speaker: And ask the same from you di ba so that mutual mutuality I guess of desires for each other's growth and what's good di ba kasi again sa akin strong talaga yung partner di ba. I even in my other aspects even in work di ba, I work best with a partner where a partner is not necessarily equal hindi ka yung laging pantay eh but it you compliment each other di ba.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: So yun eh yung I guess that dance I can't quite capture it in one word or concept exactly but if I force it there's that mutual desire for each other's that mutual desire for growth have you afford to each other because from there magsisimula lahat ng mga iba at ibang aspeto di ba. And doon nagbubunga that there's trust, there's communication, there's teamwork so on and so forth di ba kasi focus mo yung isa eh pero hindi lang you know hindi ka one way lang kung tumingin may pagkilala ka ng needs mo and that you're trusting the other that she will give that to you also and then tara let's just try to make this work step by step parang ganun sorry I'm making your life difficult.

Interviewer: No it's okay, I think I'm getting it's like an underlying principle right and from this underlying principle we have all these other ingredients that will come into place.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Because underlying principle is making sure that you give your best to the other person but at the same time you need to it's not just a one way or a unidimensional thing that you're just showing it it also requires that you as you said a while ago I think you had very good phrases here that you mentioned like a healthy dependence, independence, a healthy component, desiring for what is good for the other particularly for the other's growth and as you desire for the other's growth you also need to work on yourself something like that I think this is.

Speaker: Actually kasi parang the first five in a sense that I mentioned to you sila yung mas concrete na eh.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: Kasi at least for me di ba parang yun yung key ingredients in the spirit of pasko kung gagawa tayo ng macaroni salad di ba parang yun yung lima ko na ingredients di ba pag may isang wala dyan hindi yun yung salad ko yung limang yan. And then you can add a lot of other things more or less but the five have to be there for me and the reason why those five are there is ultimately because it's what I think would be good for you and for us so yung parang ganun.

Interviewer: Right, okay. So thank you for that yeah I think these are very even philosophical discussions when we talk about relationships and now I will move on to another topic in this interview.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: It's still abstract it's still a bit abstract but aside from relationship quality we want to narrow down on the concept of love. So medyo gasgas na but for you what is love? yeah what is love? and then I have several more questions in addition to that.

Speaker: Love is the desire and the desire for ones for the others growth and happiness and the corresponding actions that would lead to it

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: So I guess for me and your key words eh. I want to I have to want it it's my desire for the other to have growth and happiness because growth for me is not necessarily always a pleasurable thing para it can be painful but growth is always almost always at least good di ba so yung pag-anyayang lumago ultimately hindi lang yung mabigyan kiya mapasaya kita para sa kin hindi yun kulang sa akin at least yun if

it's just happiness, joy, bliss that you're after happiness and growth. And for you to find the ways to bring it to the other di ba so yun if I were to sort of capture it.

Interviewer: Right right, so the desire so I know I have there it's the desire or to want it for the other's growth desire for the other's growth and happiness with the corresponding action that will I suppose fulfill it.

Speaker: Fulfill yeah bring about the growth and happiness.

Interviewer: Right. So there even this definition of love so I have two probe questions for this even this definition that you have about love how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: Well for me so I think there is no relationship without love kasi that definition of and it's not even romantic relationships eh di ba even friendship or professional relationship in a sense dun ko pa rin iba ba to sa definition na yun but in varying degrees and the corresponding actions would vary also depending on the kind of the depending on the context of our quote-unquote relationship di ba. As a friend I would want my friend to grow and be happy and let's do things together that bring that and it could be di ba whatever is appropriate in a sense.

Speaker: In a work setting, how can we both win in the work that we do how will we both benefit from the work that we do I have to want what's good for you also not just what's good for me or at least that's how I look at it di ba. But the degree to which I would do that would vary for my wife for my child iba rin but it's like the core ingredient therefore of a healthy relationship. So yeah, sa akin it is essential so love is essential in a healthy relationship.

Interviewer: Yeah, now focusing. Thank you for that so thank you for you know elaborating on that and I also like how you mentioned that when it comes to a relationship not just we're not just talking about romantic relationships but now I would like to narrow down the discussion on love in this particular relationship that you have with [Partner's Name]. How do you know that your partner loves you? so paano yung mga indicators mo dyan that your partner.

Speaker: How do I know?

Interviewer: Yes, how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker: I guess before I get I can say that I know she loves me I have to be able to say that I know her and who she is. And to be honest it's something I it's still ongoing I've learned it kasi I have my own definitions of love and my own ways of showing love di ba that's from my perspective. And she would have her own ways of doing that also. So which is sometimes is different from mine di ba and so if I did not know her parang yung premise mo na I have to have a fair tool but increasingly intimate deep knowing of the other person to trust now ah, yan love niya ako okay so it starts with that kasi yun na, she has her own ways of expressing it right it's a firm from that point yan, I'll go to sort of two sides so the things that she does that immediately resonate with me as signs of love kasi it's my own construct parang pasok agad.

Speaker: Parang kunware physical affection hugs ganyan because I'm among tawag don sa work on five love languages right may isang way ko of pagtanggap or feeling love is actually through that. And it's not something I even do or expect from most parang it's a weird thing but so I know I want that and she does that without me asking so I feel love okay. But she also has her own ways that I've discovered along the way of our relationship na, for example siya isang strong love language niya are words of affirmation and

then gifts parang ganon okay so where did she does that so on the surface yun. But ultimately or not naman ultimate but yung for me the most felt manifestations of love is the the willingness to do things to journey together.

Speaker: Parang tara let's do this and again it would come in an array of concrete specific actions. The willingness to listen to tara upo tayo pag-usapan natin ito, the willingness to do something that you don't really enjoy yourself but because you know the other would sige. The willingness to give space and freedom di ba hindi yung constrictive. For example na lang yung two knuware hindi naman ako magimik if I needed to or would want to di ba hindi pahirapan kahit hindi kasama si [Partner's Name] di ba and sometimes siya rin ganon go take care alright. Thn tulungan o ikaw muna you have to be alone someone kailangan kasama ng kids kasi I need to do this so may saluhan.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: So all those little things I would package it within that umbrella of the willingness to co-journey di ba is this one big umbrella of signifiers of love. And then ultimate and then another is yung I'll borrow a phrase from a book that I'm sorry I can't quite remember the author right now but that willingness to enter the chaos of the other yung sakyan yung kaguluhan ng buhay niya whatever it is at lahat naman tayo ay may kanya kanyang kaguluhan chaos, internal turmoil, external turmoil whether it's work related ganyan pero yung sige nga sasabayan kita.

Speaker: To co-journey I'll be with you I'll be literally beside you and figuratively beside you so yun parang those things those elements I guess are what would tell me that [Partner's Name] and we've done that I mean I would too many little almost everyday things to mention di ba but it falls within those calendars those umbrellas and also yung mutual again the mutuality of it. Ready siyang gawin yun for me ready kong gawin yung for her and we do it also hindi lang yung readiness di ba.

Interviewer: So may action na nangyayare.

Speaker: Oo yeah. Sorry does that make sense?

Interviewer: Yeah yes, it's I think that you were able to capture what you how you actually perceive and we received the love that your partner has for you. And based on that idea of, well, you started with the idea of the identity of the person that you are, you know the person, and that based on that knowledge of the person, you're able to read how this person shows you her love. But at the same time, you also mentioned some other dimensions or indicators of that love for each other and particularly the love of this other to your partner for you by highlighting the importance of this principle of to co-journey. Yeah, and then part of that is the other indicators like being able to listen and do things together and even perhaps in the co-journey, it's not all cupcakes and rainbows di ba.

Interviewer: Yeah yeah.

Interviewer: Like you said, there's chaos. Yeah, but to co-journey with this person even in this chaos. So, thank you for that. Now, since you mentioned something about chaos, I'd like to focus on this chaos, but what would you say are the challenges or conflicts in your relationship? Are there any, of course, we're not assuming that there's challenges, but of course.

Speaker: Yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: Are there any challenges?

Speaker: Well, okay. I'll start with more practical things na.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: And wait, just to clarify when we ask for challenges meaning it's something we have as a couple identified as a challenge or what I see as my own assessment as a challenge for me in terms of our relationship, which one would it be? Both ba?

Interviewer: Well yeah, it could be both, but of course in the context of your relationship were there any conflicts or challenges that you've encountered? Of course, the more practical aspect of it is were there any, you know, any...

Speaker: Like fights or mga arguments.

Interviewer: Yes, were there any or if otherwise just general challenges in the relationship.

Speaker: Well, thankfully, you know, we haven't really had major-major relationship challenges I would say. There are misunderstandings, there are miscommunications, there are times when you know parang misinterpretations happened but very little and even fleeting. Pero di iyong tipong it didn't dwell as much kasi we also periodically and almost randomly we sort of doing sounds so geeky and weirdly even, I guess iyong parang Kumusta tayo moments? di ba parang As in literal? Is there anything about us that you think we can work on? Or is there anything about me that you think I should work on? And then the question is exchanged, so... So, I guess hindi if there are four, doesn't... I mean, yung bunga noon is that whatever challenges are parang it will arise but it gets addressed quite... I mean, hindi naman instantly pero ma-address siya without much drama.

Interviewer: Yes, yes. I just have to prevent myself from saying you know that word without so much drama.

Speaker: Yeah kasi like little things lang na different take on a certain matter different perspectives pero hindi siya nagbubunga into you know severe arguments or even tampuhan. And again, I would go back to say a number of things, one is there was just that alignment is still there. And where there is misalignment or where there are things that are new and don't really match yet may napag-uusapan.

Interviewer: All right.

Speaker: Which points to the willingness of both parties to adjust eh.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: And also the acknowledgement from both parties na hindi ganyan lang si [Partner's Name] di ba. I know na, oh, may pride yan. May, of course, tingin niya ah, si [Participant's Name] may ano yan may...nabanggit na niya rin to sakin na parang I do not have to be so strong every time. And in saying that, it was never mentioned in a manner that would make me feel attack di ba and vice versa parang feedback giving if I were to frame it in that to use it another. Parang the care is there eh di ba parang we've never, never actually parang again, ang hirap sa iyo blah, blah, blah kasi parang if you wanted to point something out nandun yung care to do it kasi the goal is again growth and happiness.

Speaker: Parang I don't, we don't dump di ba I'll use myself as an example. I used typical stereotypical of a guy, di ba yun yung action man. Pag nagusap tayo Oh Roselia anong problema ay ito dapat eh ganito dapat yun eh ganyan. But I learned early on well not actually not early on, I eventually learned that sometimes pag nar-rant siya about work or whatever typically more about work di ba. What she needs is simply for me to listen or at least for me to listen first di ba. And there was a time when she said na yun nga eh parang sometimes I just kailangan ko lang I get you I get your input yung suggestions mo and they make sense but I need you to just listen lang first.

Speaker: So she said that once she said it in a way that wasn't hindi yung ganyan na drama oh umiiyak na hindi ka nakikinig. So wala, it wasn't an intimate moment di ba parang I just need for you to be with me let me cry parang ganoon. So ako, tinandaan ko na yun yung one time na yun di ba and then oh apply that now. For every instance here actually di ba na perfectly sometimes nandoon pa rin yung okay okay so yun eh. I guess that's why it's a bit difficult for me to really particulate big challenges kasi nothing immediately at least comes to mind sakin as that.

Interviewer: Big fights?

Speaker: Oo and it's because of those things parang may there's that feedback giving there's that periodic evaluations. I don't know if it's the academic in us and the appreciation lang kasi of the other eh di ba.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: Like ako, I would tell them minsan, sabi ko, alam mo minsan ang kailangan ko lang tanungin mo lang ako how my day was and sometimes it's really just the fact that you asked is enough for me iyong tipong ganon di ba. Kasi hindi ko rin naman talaga yun nauuwi iyong quote-unquote yung mga bagay parang I am not the type to that needs unloading eh parang I've just developed a way of sort of bracketing things, work is work, ganyan is ganon. So very few things do I need to parang unload because it's too heavy.

Interviewer: Yes.

Speaker: And when I do parang yun, I tell her, can we talk about this? I need something. Kaya hindi sumasabog, I guess. Even in relation to family parang minsan I would tell well fortunately si [Partner's Name] as her parents pa ganyan. So syempre, the in-law dynamics minsan ganoon. And I would tell her, parang if something's uncomfortable for me tipong ganyan so yun. So the challenges come but they don't get out of hand enough for them to for me to have a ready answer na. Alam mo ito, si [Partner's Name] problema namin di ba wal akong mahugot agad-agad.

Interviewer: That's okay. So thank you for that. So in relation to what you have shared, I think I feel like some of the answers might fit in this next question but of course I want you to confirm. Since you mentioned some, of course these are not big fights but maybe perhaps like you were saying like challenges that were addressed and therefore you did not dwell on these. They were actually addressed and it helped you through the mechanism na binabagit mo like feedback giving and appreciation and care. Now aside from these as you mentioned, what other ways what are the other ways that you, let's say use or utilize, employ to maintain the relationship? Like it's about maintenance, yeah relationship maintenance.

Speaker: Oh, yeah. Well, apart from those, na parang there's also parang a deliberate attempt well not always nangyayare pero there's always that attempt na magkumustahan in a more in a deeper more

intimate way na magkumustahan outside of a problem hindi kita kino-kumusta kasi alam ko may problema ka parang, oh what's up? kumusta ka? kumusta tayo?. I personally prefer late night conversation so I'm more of a night person although the age we are in now parang it's a different matter pero there were times before that we'd been just being in bed talking late at night. Well, minsan magkatabi lang literal, minsan magkahawak ang kamay minsan magka-cuddle whatever but nandoon, deliberate attempts also to spend time on if more quote-unquote dates di ba? where you don't really wala agenda to talk about or anything but the agenda is just to spend time maybe try a new meal or try a favorite meal again di ba sige lang.

Speaker: But also on a day-to-day basis parang, I was just reflecting on this, the other recently parang we every day quite literally parang we would say the words I love you to each other na at least twice where the first one is in the morning and the last the second one would be at night but there would be instances in between di ba where wala lang and then we do that to the kids as well. One of our daughters our elder daughter she told me daddy hindi ako I'm not I don't like saying I love you sabi niya I don't really like hugging sabi niya okay so mayroon kaming key word that stands for I love you right now it's pickles wala random whatever words. Dati it used to be parang basa lang yung food day I forgot na pero kasi just parang sort of always express it di ba so I think that's very maintenance in a in small but consistent.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: Di ba the consistency is there. Also, we nurture each other's mga hobbies. Okay some "hobbies" we have as independent I mean independent hobbies I don't know if you see my this part like comics and I have my toys whatever she has her books mga ganyan and so music so we both play guitar I bought her guitars it's the little things eh so little things. And then again I would say we also pray together even if it's like small short prayers di ba we do it together as a family. So I guess it's the there's a certain consistency lang eh and then the occasional surprise of whatever it might be yung mga ganon.

Interviewer: Yeah okay thank you thank you so much. I think those are how would you say it you're saying of course it's in the little things you know but actually I find them really inspiring as well to hear these things from you. Yeah you should compare notes with [Partner's Name] later I'm sure you'll find or maybe one of your dates yeah you could process that would be interesting okay so sorry for keeping you so late na.

Speaker: No problem no problem.

Interviewer: The next question, so that's on maintenance. So the next question is about whether or not the relationship is good for you I feel like the answer is quite obvious but anyway I'll just throw the question. Would you say that the relationship is good for you and why? yeah this question is something to do with you know being able to it's what we call I suppose if the more practical aspect of it the function of the relationship in terms of whether or not it is good for you and of course you can specify why.

Speaker: Okay, so well I feel it is well for the a lot of the other things that I've mentioned na kanina I think support why I would say it is.

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: And just to add lang is because I've, iyon nga balikan ko yung some word na ginamit ko kanina yung there's a sense of consolation and peace. I tend to use consolation in the context especially of sorry

just to give it more context parang in Ignatian spirituality okay kasi yun yung kinalakihan ko talaga from the Jesuit training in Ignatian formation. But di ba it's consoling eh and it brings consolation brings peace walang drama wala turmoil walang glossy emotions especially the negative one so yun. So yes kasi I feel those not every time di ba na let's not be ano parang overly idealistic na yung every days is heaven because there's days na small things parang okay ayaw ko na mag-hugas ng pinggan or ayaw ko muna maligo iyong mga ganon. Si [Partner's Name] kasi iyong tipong when she gets home so ayon may routine girl si [Partner's Name] eh right she has a certain routine that helps her okay.

Speaker: I've learned to see that and I appreciate it it's nice okay I can choose to be annoyed by it but I tend I'm really not and I choose not to be. As long as parang di ba she doesn't also impose it on me but she doesn't. So bakit ko nga ba nabanggit iyon yung parang kasi mga funny little things lang na yun nga overall there's that consolation and peace. And then there's that periodic you know little frustration, little inis little di inis iyon eh di ba parang but essentially what I'm saying I guess is the good things the peace the consolation outway and outnumber whatever desolation, frustration, anger, can't even anger's not even the right word that we would experience or at least that I would experience. I like to think I can say we kasi she would tell me naman if she's experienced in that from me so yun. So yes kasi I feel those the consolation and peace outway any other negative thing that are things that are also there.

Interviewer: Yes.

Speaker: So yun.

Interviewer: Thank you thank you right. Now in relation to that did this relationship change you and if yes in what way?

Speaker: Yeah definitely na parang it's a sounds parang galing sa pelikula pero kasi it brings out a better version of me.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: It sounds it brings out yeah ano nga present tense eh it brings out kasi nga sabi practice makes hindi perfect daw practice makes permanence kasi what it's what people do. So parang ganon so I think I'm already kind kunware but I can be kinder and that also translates to other I mean it extends to other people tipong ganon.

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: To our kids to other people simply so it is good for me. Yeah nasagot ko ba?

Interviewer: Yes yes you did mention the question the really good question is did the relationship change you and you said yes definitely.

Speaker: Change me yes oo kasi nga it change me for the better

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: And again it wasn't that hindi siya yung 180 degree turn eh na well I'd like to think I'm not bad person in that sense oh change in that sense with a 180 degree but change in terms of again the growth lumalago di ba. You see your flaws you work on them you see what's good you do more of that you see something different I mean parang something new okay you examine that okay so yeah.

Interviewer: Yes yeah. So the reverse question or reverse question ba to but to add to that question so if you're saying that yes definitely you became a better version of yourself. And of course you qualify that not from being bad person to becoming a good but you know the emphasis is really more on growth. How about si [Partner's Name] as your partner did she change during the relationship was there any change in her like was she different person before compared to now that you are you know since you became partners.

Speaker: I don't again fundamentally she's still that same good person that I thought she was that I learned that she is and is still now so fundamentally ganon di ba. Hindi yung tipong may natuklasan ako na ah ganon pala siya. Even in a sige just to illustrate kunware ano ba kunware may certain what about pride si [Partner's Name] that's evident in their family it's a family thing. So I got to know that more I got to see it more closely but it was something that was there naman and then if I really actually pause and examine it it's not entirely but I get na a parte na ng ugali niya eh ganyan lang siya. And if and when it actually I see that it is doing her harm or could potentially bring harm whether to her or to us di nga we go back to our practices na teka pag-usapan natin to ay I need to point let's point this out. So kung may nagbago ba sa kanya yes but also in the same light that I mentioned it's the growth the deepening of things.

Interviewer: An enhancement perhaps I don't know.

Speaker: Enhancement di oo, kasi a lot of things di ba pag pinag-usapan ang change people tend to think of it as very dramatic, drastic, contrasting very contrasting when if you think about it change is not always that. It can be like the clouds di ba they are constantly changing but di ba the way the clouds change has never disrupted life on earth even before it becomes a storm you knew it was becoming a storm so parang ganon yung changes if anything.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Yeah

Interviewer: yeah

Speaker: But I would just have to qualify it hasn't been as it's not static train eh pero parang dama mo lang na you know you see it you sense it you can actually articulate it. But it summer is quite subtle summer is quite parang they just roll build up parang ganon.

Interviewer: Thank you thank you right. Now, another part of this question sorry but almost done but maybe a bit more like one, two, three one, two, three four major questions na lang.

Speaker: Sure.

Interviewer: Yeah so on relationship safety so the question is.

Speaker: Safety.

Interviewer: Yeah it's direct do you feel safe in the relationship and why do you say so?

Speaker: Yes kasi I know na I can trust her and that she trusts me. I know that I can depend on her as much as she can depend on me.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Ano pa ba? yeah you got so the word and again it's actually I'm sure as the researcher as the you did identify it na rin naman but katuwang is a word that I would typically use for this and then again it captures what I early it mentioned earlier na co-journey, partner, mutuality, reciprocity mga ganon.

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: So yeah, so those things bring to me feelings of being safe.

Interviewer: Safe yeah all right.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah very nice you know it's also good to reflect back on our even in our even with our own language di ba like how we use katuwang ayon na that's true so thank you. The next questions I will need a visual I need a visual aid wait let me just share my screen.

Speaker: Oh wow.

Interviewer: Yeah it's just so that you can just imagine the scale okay so let me just share that.

Speaker: Okay okay.

Interviewer: Just this one I won't do the slide I think it's quite big na man na.

Speaker: Yeah, yes yes.

Interviewer: So the first question, so it's about how responsive your partner is so the first question is straightforward then my partner usually to me and as you can see there's qualitative description as well as the scale from 1 to 9.

Speaker: Yep.

Interviewer: So you can choose any number and you can also point out the qualitative description if necessary you know but you see there from 1 to 9. What would your score be or what would you how would you answer this?

Speaker: Okay alright. So for this one let's give it an 8.

Interviewer: Right right

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah we can there's a follow up question later but let's just go through this scale.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: Two questions lang actually.

Speaker: Alright.

Interviewer: Here's the second one.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: My partner usually is responsive to my needs ayan from 1 to 9.

Speaker: Also an 8 oo also an 8.

Interviewer: Okay right. Now the follow up question okay let's go back to the first slide is of course just to qualify the number that you gave. Why did you answer 8 on 1 and for instance why not ano ba malapit?

Speaker: Why not 9?

Interviewer: Why not 9 and why not 7? although of course both are in the extreme ano naman na noh.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: But just to qualify you know and just to flesh out your answer and maybe you can cite an example perhaps why did you answer 8 instead of let's say 7 or 9?

Speaker: Yeah siguro for in both instances nalang it's more of why not 9?

Interviewer: Okay okay.

Speaker: Ayon for my sensing feeling and on parang practical. On a sensing feeling I would even have given it a 9 na alam kong ang gusto niyang makinig she put effort to listen to hear what I would want to say alright and kasi nga when we do really needs the other when we really need the other to listen we actually ask for it di ba. So the 9 why not 9? kasi simply parang di naman it sa akin it just can't be all the time as I need it on demand parang ganoon. I'm just putting it realistically pragmatically na but when I need it the most or when I really need it nandyan siya di ba so yun it's even more of that.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: Parang it's almost a practical thing lang na parang always is unreal.

Interviewer: Oo.

Speaker: To me in my own expectations kaya I can't say it's completely true yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah

Speaker: That's why it's at 8.

Interviewer: Okay and the same question for this the same follow-up question for this. So this is with respect to being responsible responsiveness the answer is 8 so why not 9 so or 7?

Speaker: Oo yeah, same thing rin and I would even say kasi sometimes tanong ko sarili ko is well did I articulate my needs clearly di ba. Just as I would tell [Partner's Name] na help me tell me as specifically as you can about what you might need instead of a sort of expecting the other to guess it and then if hindi na guess you take it against the other person parang again I find it simply a stereotypical yung babae ay kelangang parang dapat yung lalake eh mind reader daw blah blah yeah I'm sure there are people who are like that thankfully [Partner's Name] is not one of those.

Speaker: She may have those instances and I myself would have such instances when it's nice when you don't have to articulate and then they get it and then those times happen but when they don't get it I would think eh hindi mo binanggit eh hindi ko binanggit kasi I'll take it against her if she wasn't if she did seem responsive n parang that's absurd for me. It's another thing if I keep on telling you na oh ito yung

kilangang ko hindi pa rin, oh ito yung kilangang ko hindi pa rin oh di ba I will give it a lower rank maybe a 6 a 5 pero hindi naman kasi ganon di ba.

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: So yeah so it's an 8 largely because again practically speaking almost always is impossible and second I would say the underlying question to this is actually is if I have expressed it I managed my own expectations of her being a mind reader.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: So ayon.

Interviewer: Understood.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: There's one more question I'll ask that in a bit so I'll stop sharing first.

Speaker: Okay sure.

Interviewer: So the next question is some might find this quite sensitive of course because of course in any kind of relationship in marriages of course particularly there's physical intimacy. So I hope you don't by ask and feel free to say if this is too sensitive for you to share but I also want to talk about your physical intimacy as a couple just a general one like particularly of course sex and the physical intimacy in general. So how yeah no rating scale this time tumatawa nga si [Partner's Name] kanina kasi baka may rating scale din daw. So but in terms of satisfaction with respect to your physical intimacy or sex life in general what would you how would you explain it or how would you?

Speaker: describe it I mean qualify it?

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: Parang mas madali nga kung may rating scale para you can also. Yeah we're happy well I'm happy and satisfied really ano yeah ano ba yun may me there's something I tell you para. Parang mga Sunday morning post-breakfast conversations lang yun parang sabi ko pero sana pag our friends for example di ba or in their respective marriages and relationships di ba parang sana are they also intimate kaya? parang or sana they would be and sana even as we grow old di ba that intimacy is there di ba and parang it's both the physical level of intimacy and the intimacy that's not necessarily or say sexual di ba the yung mag-hawak ng kamay di ba o halikan sa noo o ang mag-hug before sleeping or before leaving the house or whatever di ba.

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: lyong mga ganon so yeah no complaints is putting it one way.

Interviewer: Right right.

Speaker: And there's even I would say sana sinabi rin niya ito there's excitement there's far as almost corny sabihin but there's that spark di ba. There's that longing, desire di ba mga ganun ba that can be both that minsan it can be comedic which is a good thing for me at least parang kaya mong it can be humorous

kasi it's light. Hindi iyong tipong kasi may forms of intimacy na parang intense iyong intimacy one point pero in between it parang as if wala naman di ba. Ito parang because it's light you can be playful, funny even with how you express it di ba like kung paano mo siya ihu-hug bigla or whatever di ba.

Speaker: So yeah and if I may add lang kasi nga I think one of the blessings, graces we had in the relationship was a certain consistency of things di ba. So parang ganon hindi yung bugso-bugso in anything I'm not even talking about physical intimacy lang eh but in general so it manifests also in that but I guess that's what I'm saying di ba. So to hold hands while walking or while doing something independently but you're beside each other is good di ba but to be able to also kiss di ba is great iyong tipong ganun. To be too tired to do anything and to talk about it the following day and laugh about it is nice di ba parang ganun. So yeah usually which is what we do iyong tipong ganon or aasarin mo so yeah oh tinulugan mo ako in the end it's not with resentment.

Interviewer: Oh right, I guess that's what commit

Speaker: Oo.

Interviewer: For the like playfulness aspect of it.

Speaker: Yeah yeah yeah mga ganon.

Interviewer: Right, okay so thank you for that and now this is the final question actually let me share my screen again so this is about wait there. So this item here the third one wait it's not changing this one so this is now in general.

Speaker: Satisfying.

Interviewer: Yeah so this is the final question for this interview and but I just will ask a follow up question in relation to this.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: But how satisfied are you with your relationship with your wife with [Partner's Name].

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So as you can see descriptive lang siya naman but if you were to choose.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Completely dissatisfied down to completely satisfied what would your answer be?

Speaker: I put it at very satisfied but I was tempted to even say completely satisfied but I do not want to give it that completely satisfied kasi I know there's more we both can give and get out of it di ba. Kasi parang again going back to that theme of growth it will grow pa eh or at least as a goal it will deepen pa di ba yung meron pa so kaya hindi ko gustong ibigay completely kasi para for me when I say I'm completely satisfied parang iyon na yun eh na puno na yung baso. Kung baga sakín ay napupuno yung baso pero lumalaki yung baso I don't know I don't have a right metaphor for what for something that does it eh yung parang habang napupuno siya the receptacle sort of like.

Interviewer: It adjust?

Speaker: Spans it like a balloon.

Interviewer: Yeah.

Speaker: But you get me yung parang ganon eh.

Interviewer: Yes.

Speaker: So yeah.

Interviewer: Alright .

Speaker: Oo.

Interviewer: Now as a follow up question.

Speaker: And also sorry if I may add lang din and again.

Interviewer: Yeah sure.

Speaker: I don't want say I don't want parang it's not perfect but it's great eh and it's fine that it's not perfect di ba I don't think perfection is a goal even eh I can growth is a goal for us for me di ba not having problems is not the goal but overcoming them facing them together is the goal di ba. Raising children as best as you can di ba modeling things for them et cetera so yun kaya I don't think I would give a perfect score anywhere likely but for those reasons.

Interviewer: Yes yes yeah. You were able to qualify naman your choice so in relation to your answer to this so you said very satisfied almost tempted to say completely satisfied I have this follow up question wait let me just look for that slide I think this is the one ayan. So for your answer when you said completely ay hindi gumalaw sandali yun ok not this one this one yan for your because you answered very satisfied to completely satisfied even. If 0 is not at all satisfied and 10 was 10 is completely satisfied, how would you now rate your satisfaction with your relationship? so this time kanina mas descriptive this time we have a scale to use to 0 to 10.

Speaker: A scale.

Interviewer: So how would you now rate kasi kanina mas descriptive lang di ba.

Speaker: So well following the scale lang edi 9 but if kayang i-push 9.5 ba but parang ganoon

Interviewer: So 9 or 9.5 ok.

Speaker: 9.5 if that's an acceptable answer but if strictly speaking doon sa ano natin sa 9.

Interviewer: 9 alright. Now just like the previous question yung follow up question ko doon since you answered 9 ok. Can you let me know why not 10 and again of course why not 8 so kasi yung nearest numeric answers dun sa tanong so if it's why not I suppose why not 10 or even why not 8?

Speaker: Again similar to my previous response it's because I know na meron pa eh in store ganyan and in a way kasi both I guess we're both of us are still also changing finding ourselves even at 40s.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: So may mga bagong elements coming up that will need some form of attention from the other di ba but also even before the attention from the other yung mismong pag-unawa mo sa sarili that self-awareness that self-management that comes for me at least that comes first eh before I even have expectations of the other or from the other di ba.

Interviewer: Oo.

Speaker: So pang I'm very very very very very very satisfied so it can even be a 9.75 di ba but to put it as completely to me is a lie also na di lang e but it doesn't mean at all that I'm looking for something pati I just know na it's like an asymptotic line di ba parang approach is zero but never actually does right.

Interviewer: Right.

Speaker: So parang ganon eh. So yes I'm happy I'm satisfied I really am but I just know na there's more and in a way that's what makes it great I guess that's what makes it nice and exciting and fun and then worthwhile so yeah.

Interviewer: Thank you thank you. Yeah I get I get your explanation and of course the metaphor of the or something that you know.

Speaker: Gumamit pa tayo ng math eh noh.

Interviewer: Yes, thank you for that. Okay so that's actually the final question right so I'll stop sharing first and then the next part lang before we end. Of course I'd like to thank you for yeah you gave you gave me so much time no and I really hope you also enjoyed the interview and I know wala ng kapalit wala kapalit na may ibibigay.

Speaker: No problem.

Interviewer: I will send an email later regarding of course your preferences with respect to let's say if you want to find out about the results of the study but at this point we're still doing data collection and as I've mentioned in the email it's a multi-country investigation so it might take a while maybe by next year. So before we end I'll just do a quick of course I will not go through the details anymore but I'll just capture some of the key points that you shared with me tonight. One is of course I'll start with I'll skip the part on demographics and context. But I think for context you did mention the importance of friendship in your relationship before it prospered into something more romantic. In terms of relationship quality you did mention that I noted here na the key word is something being blessed and stable wala masyadong drama almost like a progression.

Interviewer: As the quality relationship in comparison to let's say with your other relationships na mukhang may comparability naman because your friends' relationships were also stable and without so much drama nga and then in comparison to with your other relationships in the past what you mentioned here is you said that it's healthier there's that consoling aspect to it yung term na kapayapaan was also mentioned and there's that healthy dose of dependence and independence there's that sense of security. Okay, what else as for the let me just see my notes as for the quality your description of a high quality relationship has something to do with let me just find my notes medyo magulo yung notes ko okay the desire and alongside this you also mentioned this in response to the question on the most important thing in the relationship.

Interviewer: So you mentioned several of course na indicators but one thing that you also mentioned is like an underlying principle that there's that desire to do what's good for the other there's that desire to make sure that there's growth not just for the other person but for you as well and for the relationship as a whole. And opposite of that is when you talk about low quality relationship of course the idea is it being unhealthy and therefore being unhealthy there's mistrust and there's that battle of the egos yeah. What else and then as for the conceptualization of love use you said that okay let me see my notes ah there I wrote it somewhere else that there's the desire for the other's growth and happiness and you mentioned the importance of the corresponding action for wanting this for the other person.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: That there is and then of course you emphasize the importance of love in any relationship not just for romantic relationships you said that there's no relationship without love. As for the conflicts it seems like there are no major challenges or no major fights. But of course at the same time you also mentioned that in case that there were there were instances where some miscommunication happened I think you mentioned that these were addressed without so much drama you did not dwell on it. And in terms of relationship maintenance which you also mentioned in relation to these possible challenges ang nakatulong sa inyo were actually mechanisms such as feedback giving and that generous appreciation for the other. You also mentioned in terms of the more practical aspects of relationship maintenance you did mention about spending time deliberate

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: I think deliberate attempts ng kumustahan as well as yung spending time with each other in terms of dates. And you highlighted the importance of doing little things surprises and that is to do these things with consistency. And then you mentioned that the relationship is good for you because it gives you a sense of consolation there's peace again you did mention that as well and in terms of your identity as well as the identity of your wife. You said that yes there's change but not that drastic you know the kind of drastic change but definitely a better version of you and the emphasis always is on growth. There are subtle changes but definitely not static the subtle changes are there and in the same way you also said you mentioned earlier at first that your partner your wife is still that same person but you also see that if in case there are things that may bring harm or something to that effect that you actually pointed out but the emphasis always is on growth.

Interviewer: And then you mentioned that you feel safe in the relationship emphasizing the idea of reciprocity and mutuality the concept of katuwang and let me see if I missed anything page 22 page 23 of course you answered those scales kanina giving mainly an 8 for those answers. And mainly because the reasons are quite practical and you said that what's important is that there's still room for all these categories just like how you answered the last question on satisfaction in the relationship in general. And as far as physical intimacy and sex life for example is concerned there's what you mentioned is there's no complains about it but you also expanded the idea of intimacy to include other physical forms of intimacy beyond the actual sexual intimacy.

Interviewer: And there's you mentioned something about there's the spark and the excitement the playfulness and the light almost comedic idea behind this physical intimacy and in general you may correct you mentioned that you are very satisfied almost completely satisfied in your relationship. But you don't want somehow to give it that finality because you believe also that there's still more to give and to perhaps

get from the relationship there's still room for growth in the relationship but and the goal is not to make it a perfect relationship but the goal is to face these life's challenges and goals together as you co-journey. So I hope I was able to capture some of those key points.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: But definitely because we have the recording we'll have you know I'm sure that the project lead the project leader will be able to capture this in the transcriptions. And so now talking about transcriptions I'd like to clarify because in the consent form I did mention about yung choice niyo of how to share the data that you shared with me tonight.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So there are two options one option is to of course we want to make sure that this project this research project will be ethically transparent and so there will be some form of data sharing because there's this open science if you remember.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: There's also the link here so data sharing option but we want to know what you are most comfortable with. Option one is that transcript portions can be shared definitely none of which can be identified to you so that the identified transcript can also be read by other researchers. So usually in transcripts na yung but definitely wala reduced yung mga anything na personal like for example yung if you mention for instance [University] kanina that will be reduced.

Interviewer: So all these things that may yung very specific to you mare-reduct that's option one so transcript portions can be shared. The other option na is to the whole transcript can be shared removed of course of sensitive and overly identifying details such as the ones I mentioned so it will be anonymized for sure. So in this option there's very minimal chance that someone who knows you well can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow down who among their colleagues they believe it is although again no sensitive information will be shared. Yung portions kasi like diretso lang siguro sa ano to hindi kasi ako magtatranscribe so ako yung taga interview pero hindi ako magtatranscribe.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So the transcript will be very specific to the questions already but a whole transcript would mean you know like how we how we went through.

Speaker: Like minutes? as in minutes siya.

Interviewer: How I responded as well it will be placed there as well so that's option 2 and then of course I also want to give you the option I also mention this to [Partner's Name]. Of course tayo now in zoom kita natin yung mga mukha natin but of course you know also in zoom that we can just save the audio without our faces.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: So what would your preference be so that I can so option 1 or 2 muna and then audio or audio video?

Speaker: This is in the end product of the research paper meaning what is available to for public consumption or for tama na it's in that context?

Interviewer: Yes yes yes kasi di ba like now we upload our transcriptions and it becomes available to whoever is and they can actually use it.

Speaker: So parang it's part of kasi ano na siya study I mean research material like any other yeah yeah. Ako I'm I guess 2 is of the 3 I think 2 is the my most preferred para lang din di ba it's it's a quite in everything's quite intact minus the kasi mentioned nga the very specific attributable details so yeah so yeah sakin 2.

Interviewer: Yeah alright thank you for that and then I will be uploading the video recording to the designated drive later. So the question is do you want us nakita yung video or would you like it just audio?

Speaker: Well baka mas audio na lang.

Interviewer: Okay okay noted on that right. So yeah so that's basically it alright so I think I will note those things and then I will report this to the project leader. Again thank you so much for participating in this study of course I mentioned this.

Speaker: Thank you.

Interviewer: It's a multi country so it's also being done in Brazil, Turkey, and France as well as in the US

Speaker: Wow.

Interviewer: But of course I'm just in the Philippine team yeah. And there's also one more thing that I would like to ask you in case lang yes or no that's okay but I can resend this in the email kasi kaya yung couple na na interview the next part kasi nung aming sampling scheme is to actually ask for nominators so parang kung baga not couples. Unlike in the usual snowball na from you we will ask you to recommend another couple but this time it's going to be the nominator like si [Name] halimbawa di ba was the nominator so siya nga namin nung couples and since kaya yung na interview namin among the kasi si recommended three couples kasi that's part of the scheme kaya yung na interview namin from you ideally you will nominate you will recommend a nominator who I will contact and ask for couples kasi kailangan may.

Speaker: Ah okay gets.

Interviewer: Parang may break.

Speaker: Just someone who can nominate couples

Interviewer: Yes so ideally those couples kaya kung baga.

Speaker: Tag-isa kami ni [Partner's Name] diyan parang she gives her.

Interviewer: One nominator and then and of course we need the heads up from you kasi baka akala nila ano kami scammer or something like that.

Speaker: Oo.

Interviewer: Parang may heads up I recommended you to and of course they're free to say no to us naman but kung бага just to ask for your help again of course you've help enough but just to have if you can nominate not really nominate but recommend nominators who I will contact for the next set.

Speaker: How many might you need I mean how many do you need na recommendations?

Interviewer: Just one from you and one from [Partner's Name].

Speaker: Ah one from each of us. Okay we'll think of people kasi baka mamaya we think of the same person or masyadong magkalapit yung na isip namin pareho.

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: But yeah we'll update you on that.

Interviewer: Thank you thank you.

Speaker: Pero walang parameters na has to be male female of a certain age.

Interviewer: No naman.

Speaker: May dapat in a relationship or whatever.

Interviewer: No naman they will just

Speaker: Basta taong buhay.

Interviewer: Yes na siguro ideally taong at least may kilalang couples

Speaker: May kilalang couple.

Interviewer: Kapag medyo baka wala baka siyempre mapuputol na yung chain.

Speaker: Yeah okay well may names are coming to mind right now. But yeah we'll siguro mag-coordinate lang kami ni [Partner's Name] on it so that the net is cast properly for I mean to help you di ba.

Interviewer: Yes yes, I will send the email again parang to reiterate lang para lang mas may recall kung ano man yung request ko and then in that same email there's a link to a survey that you might want to answer of course always your choice pero but I suppose this is something to do with other things about related to the interview pero it's like it's supposed to be a short survey actually I don't know what's in there.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: But part of our task is to email that link and for you to request you to respond to it ayon.

Speaker: Yeah yeah.

Interviewer: So thank you so much.

Speaker: Okay, question lang more of a curious thing anong time line as to when the the paper itself is out and available for public consumption?

Speaker: I will you know I can ask that from Miguel kasi if you note yung sa email or sa consent form I mentioned na si Miguel sila yung actually siya yung mas nag-lead ng project and so I was invited to join him lang based on common you know mga common people that we know. And so I can ask that kung ano yung timeline nila actually medyo originally ang plano talaga nito early part of this year na eh kaya lang na de-delay you know because of the sabi ko nga yung the inherent nature also of recruiting participants.

Speaker: Yes yes.

Interviewer: Kasi yung medyo modified version ng pagkuha pag-recruit ng participants.

Speaker: Yeah yeah.

Interviewer: Kasi meron din yung comitator na nabibreak so medyo nakadepend dun sa idea na kailangan tapos mo muna yung couple bago sila mag-recomend so yun yata yung nagcacaue ng delay but you know I can easily ask that from Miguel.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: I can also echo kung ano yung target nila for the entire project.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Because it's a full time country so baka hindi ko mas sagot ng maayos ngayon yun but I will let you know.

Speaker: Saka kasi it's interesting I mean I did love to be able to read the thing not because we were one of the interviewees.

Interviewer: Yeah yeah.

Speaker: But I find it something relevant naman talaga and as a formator slash academic and father, parent kung baga parang these are things that I find important also eh. Kasi in our context na lang in the academe a lot of students who encounter problems, challenges parang rooted yun sa relationships of their parents for example that they've observed and then it somehow manifests in their own relationships ganyan. So and also to get an understanding lang din how is the world now and that's the world that our children will inherit di ba and what might that mean and what could we what's our role in it di ba parang mga ganon it's really coming from an interest perspective so thank you for doing such studies.

Interviewer: Yes.

Speaker: Good luck good luck with your work

Interviewer: We have a regular for the Philippine team our deadline is really on this December we have to end it so I'm really rushing also so but thank you so much.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: I'm so grateful you know the experience for me was also very pleasant learning from you and from [Partner's Name] I think even with just this particular session itong particular case ninyo just been really revelatory also for me. So I'm really grateful not just for the research but really for the insights that you shared and I say that with of course with sincerity thank you so much.

Speaker: Thank you also. Hopefully we get to meet. Are you based in [City A] also?

Interviewer: Yes yes.

Speaker: Ah okay okay.

Interviewer: Maybe hopefully if you come and visit now then is.

Speaker: Oh yeah yeah that would be great.

Interviewer: Alright.

Speaker: So ayon lang thank you take care.

Interviewer: Bye, it's very late na rin po.

Speaker: Para makapag-pahinga ka na rin

Interviewer: Get a successful weekend also in your family okay bye bye thank you so much.

Speaker: Bye bye god bless.

Interviewer: Thank you god bless too.

Speaker: Bye bye.